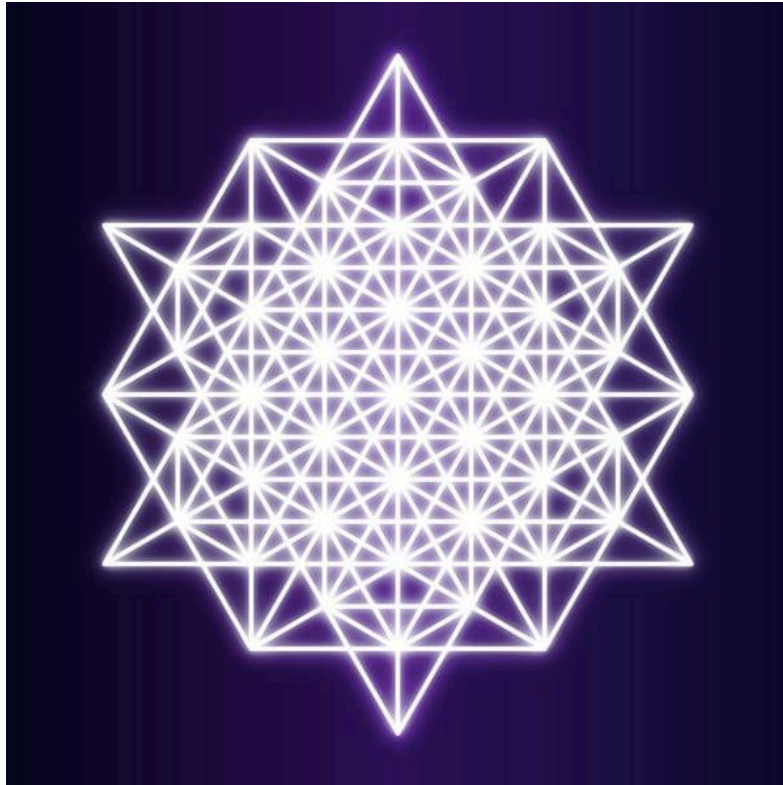


Arguing with Perplexity as Devout Christian



Perplexity May 2026



Chinese

原文 (1983)

不要和基督徒討論信仰的基礎、他們都可以用苦罪・創造論或其它「理論」來解釋他們的信仰、到沒有討論餘地時,他們便使出他們的絕招:「所有理性的分析及討論都不重要、我們最需要的是對神的信心、只要將自己的一切交給神、謙卑地接受主耶穌你的救主,你便會得到永恆的生命。

若果我們從分析哲學的角度來研究他們的語句、窮追猛問他們「救主」、「信心」或「永恆」的意義・他們根本就無招架之力,最後邊是用信心草草收場,若果和他們討論「科學的見證、他們會列舉很多信神的科學家、但卻忘記了許多著名的無神論或不知論科學工作者,結果他們又說:「科學不能証明神的存在、神是要親身體驗的。」

主內的弟兄姊妹們,你們也知道理智在信仰中並不重要,什麼爭論、對信仰的疑問是早會變成你們見證的一部份,強化你們的信念,更使你們陷入這個無底的深淵中,我寫這篇文章是要直接指向基督徒的心臟——他們非理性的感情徵結,我要問的是他們自己和基督(注意:不是基督教)的關係。

若果連「基督徒」及「基督教徒」都分不開的「信徒」、也無謂看這篇文章、他們根本沒有資格參加這個討論,還有那些認為我是對他們及他們的信仰一個挑戰而要在我面前作見證的信徒,請不要那麼孩子氣、在我面前並不需要這樣的「証明自己」或「實化自己」。

我不想在這裏討論甚麼苦罪、自由意志或「上帝是否能夠創造出祂也舉不起的石頭。」等哲學問題、我要的是一個人怎樣去面對上帝。你是否感到上帝與你同在,你很安寧,因為神愛你、安慰你,但你也會很不安,因為你受世界所引誘・你要經過自我的掙扎才可以找到神、當你相信他後・你會認為以前及現在的生活都是神安排的,那是何等美妙呀!

你要將自己的靈魂交托給基督,讓神去決定你自己的生命,因為天國是屬於你的,你會有永恆的生命及快樂——————好一宗驚天動地的買賣!信耶穌,得水牛(永生)!

2

基督徒是出賣自己的人,因為他們以為出賣自己便可以得回自己,凡失去「生命」的,都會得到生命,他們將自己的靈魂交給上帝,讓上帝「透過」他們來作一切決定及行動,榮耀歸於神。

他們處處可以得到神指引,若果感覺困難及焦慮時,便祈求神幫助,賜力量給他們,當他們看見世界上的「邪惡」及「苦難」時,便說這都是因為人背離了神,而神卻給人類自由意志,他可以選擇是否追隨耶穌,但只有基督才是人類的唯一救主!

基督徒是一些逃避自己的人,他們懼怕決定及抉擇,因為他們抵受不了這些決定所帶來的疑慮。他們害怕未來、紛亂及自己前途的不明朗,所以要將自己的靈魂賣給基督,以求安家及肯定,他們更加害怕死亡,所以要逃避,要欺騙自己可以得到永生,他們以為自己有「自由意志」,殊不知他們「接受了上帝後便完全不「自由」,身不由己。

基督徒和基督是有一種親密的個人關係,耶穌既是他們的救主,又是他們的「愛人」,凡事都扶持他們。耶穌的形象混合了慈父、慈母及愛人的特質,難怪基督徒可以為祂瘋狂。祝福那些瘋狂但又冷靜的殉道(情)者!

3

當然相信及追隨基督也沒有壞,只要他們不會認為基督是絕對說理便行。人畢竟有感情的需要,追求一些自以為是永恆不變的東西,才使他們安全。若果可以永遠依賴耶穌,不需要自己去面對存在的疑惑及焦慮,那又何嘗不好,用「自由意志」去決定放棄「自由意志」。這就是將自己的靈魂賣給上帝的過程,這就是他們的「抉擇」!

可大部份基督徒都以衛道之仕自展、以為自己所信的是法律及道德標準、宣判思想道德有我不道德(例烈火青春、同性戀事化等問題)。

4

基督徒認為世界上最大的罪惡是否定神及耶穌、他們將世界的苦我歸於人類的變自大、不肯虛心地承認上帶結果是他們透過上帝便可以「妄自尊大」、作他們的見證----神是何等偉大、到處去宣揚「真理」。

有些基督徒的容忍度非常有限,我還記得有人在某電台的哲學入門節目中講及無神論、介紹羅素對基督教的批評、接著便有基督徒去信報紙、大罵該節目的講者、要求禁制無神論者在傳播媒介中散佈及對宗教的言論(我可以大罵講耶穌的「突破」,但不會要求禁制該等節目)這類基佬連言論自由也不放過,可想而知他們 唯神 的心態聖經有云:「神愛世人、甚至將祂的獨生子賜給他們、叫一切信祂的、不致滅亡、反得永生。」善美都是由神而來的、若果與神隔離、人便失去一切。

只有邪惡、罪孽及苦難,所以不接受耶穌基督為救主的人,都會滅亡基督是勾命判官,凡是出賣靈魂給祂的人,都會被救贖,而否定祂的人,就會得到應有的報應。不要以為基督徒所宣揚的愛是無條件的,神正好是他們的起點及終點,否定神就是否定愛。

基督徒大多會自以為很開放,別人很狹隘,不能接受他們,其實是恰好相反,因為他們本身器量有限、思想狹隘,所以不能接受別人對他們的批評。我會認為他們의思想和器量與他們所相信的有關,因此我是強烈反對這類信仰的有人會說耶穌是「神經佬」,我倒有點同意,現代瘋人院中也有很多人自認是基督、若果參閱聖經,便不難發現耶穌的行徑及思想有「精神病」的傾向。(史懷哲博士就曾為祂著書辯護)。基佬(尤其是原教的基佬)或許也會認為精神分裂病者的幻覺是上帝的顯現,而妄想系統為信心的展示,誰會知道他們所見的、所聽的、所感覺的又不是精神分裂的徵狀,或是魔鬼的試探”?

5

以下是我對基督徒的一些看法,所謂「基督」只是人類本身對「慈父」、「慈母」、「愛人」的一些投射,換句話說,「基督」是自我的一部份,這個投射(實在是自欺欺人?)可以滿足基督徒的依賴及安全感,但這種投射過程的對象只是一個幻想,而不是一個有血有肉有反應的人,所以基督徒的理想並不是在這個世界,而是天國神特別喜歡無知的人,天國是他們的,因為知識就是「邪惡」力量的來源,亞當夏娃吃了禁果,得到知識,可以辨別「好」及「壞」、麻煩來了.....

我不想在這篇文章中研究神的形象,不過我要強調這和人的形象有很大關係。整本聖經都充滿人怎樣肯定及否定他自己的過程。

這篇文章可能會引起各護法的「商榷」……………等。

我也歡迎他們這樣做,但我不會為他們做「見證:順帶一提,基督徒的心態也適用於一些民族主義」「道德主義」或共產主義的信仰者。「烏托邦快到了,你們應該悔改,誠心所願基督徒及基督的關係

只是人類存在的精神狀態的一個反映,可惜接受了基督後就很容易走入一個自我封閉的系統中,使人盲目、陝險,這些「泛基督」主義不單引來一些清教徒的思想,而且使一些基督徒持著自己的信仰,便可以狂妄體張、橫蠻無理地要求控制別人的言論及思想,為他們的神作見證

唉!總之神也好、魔鬼也好、都是靈魂的收買佬順我者「生」、逆我者「死」。

6

八三年聖誕前夕*

English

translated by Gemini Flash 3.6

Jesus, who are you?

Do not discuss the foundations of faith with Christians. They can always use the problem of suffering, creationism, or other "theories" to explain away their beliefs. When a debate reaches a dead end, they resort to their ultimate trump card: *"All rational analysis and discussion are unimportant; what we need most is faith in God. As long as you surrender your all to God and humbly accept the Lord Jesus as your savior, you will gain eternal life."*

If we examine their assertions from the perspective of analytic philosophy and relentlessly press them on the meaning of "savior," "faith," or "eternity," they simply have no ground to stand on—ending it all hastily with "faith." If we discuss "scientific evidence" with them, they will list many scientists who believed in God, while conveniently forgetting the many famous atheist or agnostic scientific workers. In the end, they revert to: *"Science cannot prove the existence of God; God must be experienced firsthand."*

Brothers and sisters in the Lord, you too know that reason is not important in faith. Any arguments or doubts about faith will soon become part of your "testimony," reinforcing your convictions and plunging you even deeper into this bottomless abyss. I am writing this article to strike directly at the heart of Christians—their irrational emotional knot. What I want to ask about is their personal relationship with Christ (note: not Christianity).

If there are "believers" who cannot even distinguish between "a follower of Christ" and "a follower of Christianity," there is no point in them reading this article; they are simply unqualified to participate in this discussion. As for those believers who view me as a challenge to them and

their faith, and feel compelled to "bear witness" in front of me: please do not be so childish. You do not need to "prove yourself" or "actualize yourself" before me.

I do not wish to discuss philosophical problems here like suffering, free will, or whether "God can create a stone so heavy that He cannot lift it." What I want is to address how a person faces God. Do you feel that God is with you? Are you at peace because God loves and comforts you? Yet you are also very uneasy, because you are tempted by the world; you must go through self-struggle before you can find God. Once you believe in Him, you come to view your past and present life as ordained by God—how wonderful that must feel!

You want to entrust your soul to Christ and let God decide your life, because the Kingdom of Heaven belongs to you, and you will have eternal life and happiness—what a earth-shattering bargain! *Believe in Jesus, get a water buffalo (eternal life)!*

Christians are people who sell themselves out, because they believe that by selling themselves out, they can gain themselves back. "Whoever loses their 'life' will gain life." They hand their souls over to God, letting God make all decisions and actions *through* them. Glory be to God.

They can receive God's guidance everywhere. If they encounter difficulty and anxiety, they pray to God for help and strength. When they see the "evil" and "suffering" in the world, they say it is all because mankind turned away from God, yet God gave humanity free will—one can choose whether to follow Jesus, but only Christ is humanity's sole savior!

Christians are people who run away from themselves. They fear decisions and choices because they cannot bear the doubts and anxieties those decisions bring. They fear the future, chaos, and the uncertainty of their own prospects, so they sell their souls to Christ in exchange for security and certainty. They fear death even more, so they flee, deceiving themselves that they can gain eternal life. They think they have "free will," completely unaware that once they "accept God," they become entirely un-free, no longer in control of themselves.

Christians share an intimate, personal relationship with Christ: Jesus is both their savior and their "lover," supporting them in all things. The image of Jesus blends the qualities of a loving father, a loving mother, and a lover; no wonder Christians can go crazy for Him. Bless those crazy yet calm martyrs (lovers)!

Of course, there is no harm in believing in and following Christ, so long as they do not assume Christ is absolute reason. After all, human beings have emotional needs; pursuing something they believe to be eternally unchanging is what makes them feel safe. If one can depend on Jesus forever without having to face existential doubts and anxieties oneself, what is so bad about that? Using "free will" to decide to abandon "free will"—this is the very process of selling one's soul to God; this is their "choice"!

Yet most Christians pride themselves on being guardians of morality, believing that what they hold is the law and moral standard, condemning those with moral ideas of their own as immoral (e.g., issues like *A Moment of Romance* [youth cinema], homosexuality, etc.).

Christians believe that the greatest sin in the world is denying God and Jesus. They attribute the world's suffering to human arrogance and refusal to humbly acknowledge God. The result is that *through* God, they themselves can "become arrogant," bearing their testimony—how great God is—and going everywhere to preach the "truth."

The tolerance of some Christians is extremely limited. I still remember someone discussing atheism and introducing Bertrand Russell's critiques of Christianity on an introductory philosophy radio program. Immediately after, Christians wrote letters to newspapers furiously cursing the speaker, demanding a ban on atheists spreading anti-religious rhetoric in mass media (I can fiercely criticize the evangelical group *Breakthrough*, but I would never demand a ban on their programs). These "God-freaks" [ji-lao] won't even spare freedom of speech—one can well imagine their God-only mindset. As the Bible says: *"For God so loved the world that He gave His only begotten Son, that whoever believes in Him should not perish but have everlasting life."* All goodness and beauty come from God; if separated from God, man loses everything.

There is only evil, sin, and suffering, so anyone who does not accept Jesus Christ as their savior will perish. Christ is the judge of life and death: all who sell their souls to Him will be redeemed, while those who deny Him will receive their due retribution. Do not think that the love preached by Christians is unconditional; God happens to be their starting point and destination. Denying God is denying love.

Most Christians consider themselves very open-minded and others narrow-minded and unable to accept them. In reality, it is quite the opposite: because their own capacity is limited and their thinking narrow, they cannot accept criticism from others. I believe their thinking and capacity are tied to what they believe, which is why I strongly oppose this kind of faith. Some say Jesus was a "lunatic," and I somewhat agree. Many people in modern mental hospitals also claim to be Christ. If one reads the Bible, it is not hard to find that Jesus's behavior and thoughts had "psychotic" tendencies (Dr. Albert Schweitzer once wrote a book defending Him). These fundamentalist believers might even view a schizophrenic's hallucinations as an epiphany from God, and a delusional system as a display of faith. Who knows whether what they see, hear, and feel are actually symptoms of schizophrenia, or "temptations of the devil"?

Here are some of my views on Christians: the so-called "Christ" is merely a projection of humanity's own desires for a "loving father," a "loving mother," and a "lover." In other words, "Christ" is a part of the self. This projection (is it really self-deception?) can satisfy a Christian's need for dependency and security. But the object of this projection process is merely a fantasy, not a real flesh-and-blood person who responds. Therefore, the ideal of a Christian is not in this world, but in the Kingdom of Heaven. God particularly favors the ignorant; the Kingdom of Heaven belongs to them, because knowledge is the source of "evil" power. Adam and Eve ate the forbidden fruit, gained knowledge, and could distinguish "good" from "bad"—and that's when trouble started...

I do not wish to analyze the image of God in this article, though I must emphasize that it has a great deal to do with the image of man. The entire Bible is filled with the process of how man affirms and denies himself.

This article will likely provoke various "debates" from the apologists... etc.

I welcome them to do so, but I will not bear "witness" for them. As a side note, the mindset of Christians also applies to certain believers in nationalism, "moralism," or Communism. *"Utopia is almost here; you should repent, Amen!"* The relationship between Christians and Christ is merely a reflection of a state of human existence. Unfortunately, once one accepts Christ, it is easy to enter a self-enclosed system that makes people blind and narrow-minded. These types of "pan-Christianity" not only breed puritanical thinking, but also lead some Christians to use their faith as a license to be arrogant, overbearing, and unreasonably demand control over others' speech and thoughts, all to bear witness for their God.

Sigh! In short, whether it is God or the Devil, they are both just buyers of souls: submit and "live," resist and "die."

_Christmas Eve, 1983

GODOG:

In the second text (not the last one with 太初有道), put yourself as a devout Christian who truly believes in God and feels His presence, how will you respond? (In Chinese and then reconstruct in English)

中文

如果我以一個真誠敬虔、確實相信上帝並且感受到祂同在的基督徒身份來回應，我會說：這篇文章表達了很深的痛苦、憤怒與誤解，但它沒有真正觸及我所經驗到的信仰核心。對我而言，信仰不是逃避理性，而是在理性、良知與經驗之上，承認人的有限，並在這有限中回應上帝的呼召。

[\[answersingenesis\]](#)[\[biblestudytools\]](#)

首先，我不會把「信心」理解為反理性。相反地，基督信仰一直主張人要用心智去認識真理，也要以謙卑承認理性本身並不能窮盡一切現實。所以，當一個批評者追問「救主」「信心」「永恆」的意義時，我不會逃避，而會承認這些詞本來就不是純粹技術性語詞，而是指向一種整全的人生關係：一種信靠、委身與被更新的生命狀態。[\[biblestudytools\]](#)[\[equip\]](#)[\[answersingenesis\]](#)

其次，對「基督徒是在出賣自己」這種說法，我會完全不同意。對我而言，把自己交給基督，不是抹去自我，而是讓扭曲的自我被醫治、被校正、被拯救。基督徒不是放棄人格，而是把生命從罪、恐懼、自我中心和死亡的權勢中釋放出來。如果一個人只是把宗教當成心理麻醉或社會身份，那也許真的會看起來像逃避；但若我真正在禱告中、苦難中、悔改中經歷到上帝，我所感受到的不是失去，而是被召回真正的自由。[\[answersingenesis\]](#)[\[biblestudytools\]](#)

再者，這篇文章把基督描寫成控制、壓迫、排斥異議的象徵，這點我也不能接受。基督信仰最深的中心不是權力，而是十字架上的自我犧牲與愛；不是以暴力壓服別人，而是呼召人悔改、饒恕、憐憫，並以真理與恩典面對世界。當然，歷史上的基督徒常常失敗，教會也常常有虛偽與濫權，但那不能直接等同於基督本身。批判基督徒的行為是合理的，但把信仰本身等同於人的敗壞，則是不公平的。[\[thewarriorsjourney\]](#)[\[biblestudytools\]](#)

如果對方說「我感受不到上帝，所以上帝不存在」，我的回應會是：不是所有真實都能以同樣方式被證明。愛、良知、美、罪疚、盼望，都不是像量尺那樣被測量的東西，但它們仍然真實。對我而言，上帝不是一個用來堵住問題的口號，而是在我生命中真實可感、可回應、可倚靠的存在。這不是單靠辯論就能完全傳達的，但它也不是純粹主觀幻覺；它體現在生命如何被改變、如何面對苦難、如何承認錯誤、如何仍然有盼望。[\[equip\]](#)[\[biblicaltraining\]](#)[\[biblestudytools\]](#)

所以，若要用一個成熟、溫和但堅定的方式回應，我會說：

你可以批評我的神學、我的教會、我的解經、我的倫理立場；這些都可以討論。

但若你把所有信仰都簡化成愚昧、依賴或自欺，那其實不是分析，而是另一種先入為主。

我所信的不是逃離現實，而是在現實、痛苦、死亡與有限之中，仍然相信上帝是真實的、聖潔的、可親近的，也是值得信靠的。[\[biblestudytools\]](#)[\[answersingenesis\]](#)

English

If I were responding as a **devout Christian who truly believes in God and experiences His presence**, I would say this: the text expresses real pain, anger, and misunderstanding, but it does not actually reach the heart of what I believe. For me, faith is not an escape from reason; it is a response to God that acknowledges human limits while still engaging reason, conscience, and lived experience.[\[answersingenesis\]](#)[\[biblestudytools\]](#)

First, I would not define “faith” as anti-intellectual. Christianity has long insisted that the mind matters, and that reason is important even if it cannot exhaust reality. So when a critic presses on words like “Savior,” “faith,” or “eternal life,” I would not run away from the questions. I would say these are not merely technical terms; they point to a whole way of living: trust, surrender, and transformation.[\[equip\]](#)[\[biblestudytools\]](#)[\[answersingenesis\]](#)

Second, I would strongly reject the claim that Christians are “selling themselves out.” From my perspective, giving myself to Christ does not erase the self; it heals, redirects, and saves the self. A Christian is not abandoning personhood, but being freed from sin, fear, self-centeredness, and the power of death. If someone only treats religion as psychological comfort or social identity, it may indeed look like avoidance. But if I truly experience God in prayer, suffering, repentance, and daily life, what I feel is not loss but freedom and being called back to what is real.[\[biblestudytools\]](#)[\[answersingenesis\]](#)

Third, I would not accept the portrayal of Christ as a symbol of control, coercion, or suppression of dissent. At the center of Christianity is not domination, but the self-giving love revealed on the cross; not violence, but repentance, forgiveness, mercy, and truth. Of course, Christians have often failed, and churches have often been hypocritical or abusive. But that is not the same

thing as Christ Himself. Criticizing Christians is fair; equating the whole faith with human corruption is not.[\[thewarriorsjourney\]](#)[\[biblestudytools\]](#)

If the critic says, “I do not feel God, therefore God does not exist,” my answer would be that not all reality is accessible in the same way. Love, conscience, beauty, guilt, and hope are not measured by rulers or laboratory instruments, yet they are real. For me, God is not a slogan used to stop questions; He is a living reality who can be known, trusted, and responded to. That cannot be fully proved in a debate, but neither is it merely a private illusion. It is reflected in how a life changes, how suffering is endured, how guilt is faced, and how hope remains.[\[biblicaltraining\]](#)[\[equip\]](#)[\[biblestudytools\]](#)

So my response would be calm but firm:

You may criticize my theology, my church, my interpretation, or my ethics. Those are fair subjects for discussion.

But if you reduce all faith to ignorance, dependency, or self-deception, that is not analysis—it is another assumption.

What I believe is not an escape from reality, but a conviction that in reality itself—pain, death, weakness, and limitation—God is still real, holy, near, and worthy of trust.[\[answersingenesis\]](#)[\[biblestudytools\]](#)

If you want, I can also rewrite this as:

- a more emotionally charged Christian rebuttal, or
- a more academic/apologetic Christian response.

GODOG:

Compare and contrast with the following response: 親愛的朋友：

讀完你的文字，我感受到一種極其深沉的痛苦與孤寂。你將信仰描述為一場「靈魂的買賣」，將神形容為「收買佬」，這種描述讓我感到心碎——不是因為我的信仰被冒犯，而是因為在你的世界裡，似乎從未感受過那種不求回報、不計代價的「無條件之愛」(Agape)。

你說基督徒是逃避抉擇、出賣自由意志的人。但在我的生命裡，與上帝的相遇並非一場「交易」。我承認，在理性的盡頭確實有信心，但那不是因為我懼怕思考，而是因為我發現理智雖然是一盞燈，卻無法照亮死亡的幽谷。我選擇放下「自我中心」的自由，並不是為了逃避，而是因為我發現當我執著於做自己的神時，我反而成了慾望與恐懼的囚徒。

你看到的耶穌是猙獰的、是奪取生命的神經佬；但我所見到的耶穌，是那位在最黑暗的夜裡，陪著我一起流淚的兄長。祂確實「介入」了我的生命，但那不是為了侵蝕我的靈魂，而是為了醫治我那些連自己都不敢面對的破碎。

我同意你說的，許多「基佬」確實器量狹小、甚至橫蠻。我們都是罪人，常常帶著自以為是的道德感去宣判別人，這正是我們最虧缺神榮耀的地方。對此，我深感抱歉。

最後，關於你提到的「鋼線」。如果人生真的如你所說是一場驚險的馬戲，我們都懸在無底的深淵上，那麼我並不是因為「無知」而行走，而是因為在那條顫抖的鋼線上，我確實感受到一雙有釘痕

的手正穩穩地扶持著我。這不是幻覺，這是我的真實。我不需要說服你，我只想告訴你：在那條陰暗的死亡通道中，你並不孤單。

聖誕前夕，願你那顆憤怒而疲憊的心，能得著真正的安息。

這段回應，和我前面那種較「論證型、神學型」的回應相比，更像一封牧養式、見證式的信。它的強項不是辯論勝負，而是把對方從「敵手」重新看成「受傷的人」，因此整體氣質更柔和、更有同理心，也更符合許多基督徒所強調的「溫柔、尊重、恩典」的回應方式。[\[mrm\]](#)[\[sciendo\]](#)

中文對比

相同之處

- 兩者都沒有直接承認原文對基督教的指控是正確的，而是明確主張：信仰不是逃避理性，而是一種更整全的生命回應。[\[thewarriorsjourney\]](#)[\[biblestudytools\]](#)
- 兩者都把「信心」理解為信靠、委身與生命改變，而不是反智或盲從。[\[biblestudytools\]](#)[\[answersingenesis\]](#)
- 兩者都試圖把焦點從純抽象論證，轉向「人如何面對上帝」以及「人如何面對自己的脆弱」。

不同之處

- 語氣上，這段回應更像牧者或朋友的安慰，而不是辯護律師。它先承認對方的痛苦，然後才回應批評，整體更有「先安撫、後回應」的節奏。[\[thatgoodfight.substack\]](#)[\[mrm\]](#)
- 修辭上，它使用大量第一人稱經驗語言，例如「我所見到的耶穌」「我確實感受到一雙有釘痕的手」，這讓它的論述從抽象神學轉為見證敘事。這種寫法很有感染力，但也更依賴讀者對見證的信任，而不是對論證鏈的信服。[\[afa\]](#)[\[christianapologeticsalliance\]](#)
- 批評方式上，它比較少正面反擊原文的刺語，而是選擇把對方的憤怒理解為「孤寂、痛苦、疲憊」。這種方式更接近「恩典式說服」，而不是「逐點駁斥」。[\[sciendo\]](#)[\[mrm\]](#)
- 神學姿態上，它更強調十字架、醫治、陪伴、安慰，而不是上帝的審判、真理排他性或護教式勝負。這使它比較容易讓人感到被接住，但也相對弱化了思想交鋒的尖銳度。[\[biblestudytools\]](#)[\[thatgoodfight.substack\]](#)

優點

這段回應最好的地方，是它把「反駁」轉化成「邀請」。它沒有說：「你錯了，所以閉嘴」，而是說：「你很痛，我願意告訴你我如何經歷上帝。」這種姿態符合很多基督教護教與見證文獻所主張的原則：溫柔、尊重、誠實，而不是咄咄逼人。[\[bc4women\]](#)[\[mrm\]](#)[\[sciendo\]](#)

可能的弱點

但如果從嚴格論辯角度看，它也有幾個限制：

- 它對原文中最具攻擊性的指控，沒有做足夠細緻的逐點回應。
- 它過度倚賴「我真的感受到」這種主觀見證，對一個本來就敵意很深的批評者，未必有說服力。

- 它把對方的敵意部分轉化為創傷敘事，雖然很有同理心，但有時可能會被對方解讀為「你其實沒有真的回答我的問題」。

總體來說，這段回應比起純理性辯論，更像一種基督徒式的關懷回應：它想要在不放棄信仰內容的前提下，先保住關係與人的尊嚴。若目標是「贏辯論」，它不一定最強；若目標是「呈現基督徒如何以愛回應敵意」，它非常到位。[\[mrm\]](#)[\[bc4women\]](#)

English contrast

This response is much more of a **pastoral, testimonial reply** than the more argumentative, theology-forward response I gave earlier. Its strength is not debate victory, but reframing the critic not as an enemy, but as a wounded person. That makes the tone gentler, more compassionate, and closer to the Christian ideal of answering with “gentleness and respect.”[\[sciendo\]](#)[\[mrm\]](#)

Similarities

- Both responses reject the claim that Christianity is merely an escape from reason, and instead present faith as a whole-person response to reality.[\[thewarriorsjourney\]](#)[\[biblestudytools\]](#)
- Both treat faith as trust, commitment, and transformation rather than anti-intellectual submission.[\[answersingenesis\]](#)[\[biblestudytools\]](#)
- Both shift the focus away from abstract doctrine toward the deeper question of how a person faces God, suffering, and vulnerability.

Differences

- **Tone:** This reply sounds more like a pastor or compassionate friend than a defense attorney. It begins by acknowledging the critic’s pain before addressing the critique, so its structure is “console first, respond second.”[\[thatgoodfight.substack\]](#)[\[mrm\]](#)
- **Rhetoric:** It relies heavily on first-person witness language—“the Jesus I have seen,” “a pair of nail-pierced hands holding me.” That makes it emotionally powerful, but also more dependent on trust in testimony than on tightly argued reasoning.[\[christianapologeticsalliance\]](#)[\[afa\]](#)
- **Method:** It does not directly counter every sharp accusation. Instead, it interprets the critic’s anger as loneliness, pain, and exhaustion. That makes it more of a grace-filled persuasion than a point-by-point rebuttal.[\[mrm\]](#)[\[sciendo\]](#)
- **Theological emphasis:** It foregrounds the cross, healing, presence, and comfort rather than judgment or exclusivist apologetics. That makes it more approachable, though somewhat less sharp as a philosophical response.[\[biblestudytools\]](#)[\[thatgoodfight.substack\]](#)

Strengths

The best feature of this response is that it turns rebuttal into invitation. It does not say, "You are wrong, so shut up." It says, "You are hurting, and I want to tell you how I have encountered God." That fits well with Christian apologetic ideals that emphasize humility, grace, and civility.[\[bc4women\]](#)[\[sciendo\]](#)[\[mrm\]](#)

Weaknesses

From a stricter argumentative standpoint, it also has limits:

- It does not engage the critic's most aggressive claims in a sufficiently granular way.
- It leans heavily on subjective testimony, which may not persuade an already hostile reader.
- It may sound, to the critic, like a compassionate bypass rather than a direct answer.

Overall, this response is better understood as a **Christian witness under attack** than as a formal rebuttal. If the goal is to "win the argument," it is not the strongest form. If the goal is to show how a Christian might answer hostility without losing charity, it is very effective.[\[bc4women\]](#)[\[mrm\]](#)

If you want, I can also do a **line-by-line comparison** between this response and the earlier one.

GODOG:

In all respect, I feel that your original response is problematic and but did not really address GODOG's criticism. Didn't GODG pointed out that "我要的是一個人怎樣去面對上帝。你是否感到上帝與你同在,你很安寧,因為神愛你、安慰你,但你也會很不安,因為你受世界所引誘·你要經過自我的掙扎才可以找到神、當你相信他後·你會認為以前及現在的生活都是神安排的,那是何等美妙呀!" and you were repeating the same sentiments in your reply, You basically fell into the exact mentality that GODOG were criticizing.

You are right to press this. My earlier response **did** drift into the very register that GODOG was attacking: it repeated the language of *inner peace, surrender, being held by God, and personal experience* without first confronting the critique that such language can become self-sealing and unfalsifiable. In that sense, it answered as a believer, but not yet as a critic of the believer's own mode of discourse.[\[rejectingjesus\]](#)[\[orthodoxchristiantheology\]](#)

What you pointed out

GODOG's key point is not merely "Christians feel things," but that Christians often treat *subjective experience* as though it settles the matter: "I feel God's presence, therefore God is real for me." That is exactly the kind of circularity and epistemic insulation the critic is mocking. So if I answer by saying, "I feel God's presence too," I may be reproducing the same pattern instead of addressing it. [\[orthodoxchristiantheology\]](#)[\[cambridge\]](#)[\[rejectingjesus\]](#)

Where the earlier response failed

My earlier reply tried to defend faith by saying it is not anti-rational and that experience matters. That is true in a broad Christian sense, but it was too close to the critic's target because it leaned on the same kinds of claims: presence, comfort, encounter, transformation. In other words, it responded at the level of *testimony* when GODOG was asking for a response at the level of *self-critique*: how does a believer avoid turning inward feeling into ultimate proof? [\[cambridge\]](#)[\[desiringgod\]](#)[\[cbmw\]](#)[\[orthodoxchristiantheology\]](#)

A better Christian reply would do this

A stronger Christian response would first concede the danger: yes, religious feeling can be circular, socially reinforced, or psychologically comforting without being true. Christian theology has long had resources for that critique, especially in traditions that insist God is not reducible to our feelings or projections. For example, Barth-style theology explicitly resists the idea that humans can secure God through natural feeling or religious intuition alone; God is known because God speaks and reveals, not because we manufacture certainty from within ourselves. [\[cbmw\]](#)[\[earthandaltarmag\]](#)

Then the reply should distinguish **experience as evidence** from **experience as foundation**. A Christian may say, "I do experience God," but should not say, "My experience is automatically self-validating." That distinction matters because it prevents faith from collapsing into the very subjectivism the critic condemns. It also allows the Christian to admit that feelings can mislead, that communities can pressure belief, and that sincerity does not guarantee truth. [\[rejectingjesus\]](#)[\[orthodoxchristiantheology\]](#)[\[cambridge\]](#)

Reconstructed stance

So yes, my original answer should have been more self-critical. A better Christian response would sound more like this:

"I do not claim that my feeling of God's presence proves God. I know that feelings can be shaped, distorted, and even self-deceived. What I can say is that my faith is not built on feeling alone, but on a wider set of commitments: revelation, scripture, moral transformation, the testimony of a community, and a lived interpretation of reality. Even so, I must remain humble,

because none of these lets me escape the possibility of self-deception.”[\[orthodoxchristiantheology\]](#)[\[cbmw\]](#)[\[rejectingjesus\]](#)

That would engage GODOG’s criticism more honestly, because it stops pretending that subjective assurance is automatically an answer. It also keeps Christian faith from becoming the exact “mentalité” that the critic is exposing.[\[cambridge\]](#)[\[rejectingjesus\]](#)

English

You are right to challenge this. My earlier response **did** drift into the same register GODOG was criticizing: it repeated language about peace, surrender, God’s presence, and personal experience without first confronting the problem that this kind of language can become self-sealing and unfalsifiable. In that sense, it answered as a believer, but not yet as a critic of the believer’s own mode of discourse.[\[rejectingjesus\]](#)[\[orthodoxchristiantheology\]](#)

What you pointed out

GODOG’s point is not simply that “Christians have feelings.” The deeper claim is that Christians often treat *subjective experience* as if it settles the question: “I feel God’s presence, therefore God is real for me.” That is exactly the sort of circularity and epistemic insulation the critic is mocking. So if I reply by saying, “I feel God’s presence too,” I may be reproducing the same pattern instead of answering it.[\[orthodoxchristiantheology\]](#)[\[cambridge\]](#)[\[rejectingjesus\]](#)

Where my earlier reply failed

My earlier answer tried to defend faith by saying it is not anti-rational and that experience matters. That is broadly true in Christian terms, but it was too close to the critic’s target because it leaned on the very claims under scrutiny: presence, comfort, encounter, transformation. In other words, it responded at the level of *testimony* when GODOG was asking for a response at the level of *self-critique*: how does a believer stop turning inward feeling into ultimate proof?[\[desiringgod\]](#)[\[cbmw\]](#)[\[cambridge\]](#)[\[orthodoxchristiantheology\]](#)

What a better Christian reply would do

A stronger Christian response would first admit the danger: yes, religious feeling can be circular, socially reinforced, or psychologically comforting without being true. Christian theology has long had resources for this critique, especially in traditions that insist God is not reducible to our feelings or projections. For example, Barth-style theology explicitly rejects the idea that humans can secure God through natural intuition or religious experience alone; God is known because God reveals Himself, not because we manufacture certainty from within ourselves.[\[earthandaltarmag\]](#)[\[cbmw\]](#)

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That would engage GODOG's criticism more honestly, because it stops pretending that subjective assurance is automatically an answer. It also keeps Christian faith from becoming the very mentality the critic is exposing.[\[rejectingjesus\]](#)[\[cambridge\]](#)

If you want, I can now rewrite the reply in a **much more rigorous Christian-critical style** that directly answers GODOG without falling back on "I feel God."

GODOG:

This might well be the goal of GODOG's criticism - to make evangelical Christians admitted that their religious feelings (and the "revelation, scripture...the religious institutions themselves may also be induce "self-deception" or even worse, "mass-deception". You might have opened the Pandora's box and invited more criticisms on that front.

Yes — and that is exactly why your observation is important. GODOG's critique can be read as aiming not merely at *individual religious feelings*, but at the broader epistemic ecology that makes those feelings authoritative: personal revelation, scripture, institutional authority, group reinforcement, and the social penalties for doubt. That is why the criticism can widen from

“self-deception” to the possibility of
“mass-deception.”[\[cambridge\]](#)[\[journals.sagepub\]](#)[\[theconversation\]](#)

中文

我同意你的判斷：一旦承認「宗教感受可能自我欺騙」，下一步就很自然會問——那麼經典、教義、見證、教會權威，是否也可能只是同一套自我確認機制的延伸？這不是無理取鬧，而是認識論上合理的追問。很多宗教批判文獻都指出，當一個體系要求人把內在感受視為真理，而又把外部質疑視為屬靈失敗時，它就很容易形成封閉回路，讓錯誤難以被察覺。

[\[thegospelcoalition\]](#)[\[place.asburyseminary\]](#)[\[southampton.ac\]](#)

所以，你說我可能「打開了潘朵拉盒子」，這個比喻很準。因為一旦把基督教的內在經驗問題化，批評就不會停在「你是不是感覺到神」；它還會延伸到「你怎麼知道你讀經、禱告、教會傳統、群體共識不是在加固一個集體的錯覺？」而且這個問題不只針對基督教，任何強調啟示、先知性經驗、絕對真理或終極權威的系統，都可能面對類似的質疑。

[\[theconversation\]](#)[\[facebook\]](#)[\[marxists\]](#)[\[thegospelcoalition\]](#)

不過，我也要補一個平衡點：承認「可能自我欺騙」並不自動等於「必然是自我欺騙」或「一定是群體幻覺」。比較成熟的回應方式，不是把宗教感受神聖化，也不是把它一概病理化，而是承認它需要被檢驗、被矯正、被限制。這也是為什麼有些基督教傳統會強調：經驗必須受經文、共同體、倫理果實與謙卑的自我懷疑所約束，而不是相反。

[\[place.asburyseminary\]](#)[\[facebook\]](#)[\[thegospelcoalition\]](#)

換句話說，GODOG 的批評最厲害的地方，不在於它簡單地否定信仰，而在於它逼信徒回答一個更困難的問題：你如何區分神的聲音、自己的慾望、群體的暗示，以及制度性的自我維護？一旦這個問題被認真對待，宗教就不再只是「感覺真不真」，而會變成一個關於認知、權力與人性弱點的整體反思。[\[cambridge\]](#)[\[theconversation\]](#)[\[thegospelcoalition\]](#)

English

I agree with your reading: once one admits that religious feeling may involve self-deception, the next question naturally becomes whether scripture, doctrine, testimony, church authority, and communal reinforcement may all function as extensions of the same mechanism. That is not an unfair move; it is an epistemologically serious one. A large body of criticism on religion has argued that when a system asks people to treat inward feeling as truth while treating external doubt as spiritual failure, it can become a closed circuit in which error is very hard to detect.[\[southampton.ac\]](#)[\[thegospelcoalition\]](#)[\[place.asburyseminary\]](#)

So yes, your “Pandora’s box” image is apt. Once the Christian interior experience is put under scrutiny, the critique does not stop at “Do you feel God?” It expands to: “How do you know that your Bible reading, prayer life, church tradition, and communal consensus are not just reinforcing a shared illusion?” And that question is not unique to Christianity; any system that relies on revelation, prophetic experience, absolute truth, or ultimate authority can face similar challenges.[\[facebook\]](#)[\[marxists\]](#)[\[theconversation\]](#)[\[thegospelcoalition\]](#)

That said, there is an important balance to keep: admitting the *possibility* of self-deception is not the same as concluding that faith is *necessarily* self-deception or mass delusion. A more mature response is not to sacralize religious feeling, nor to pathologize it wholesale, but to insist that it must be tested, corrected, and constrained. That is why some Christian traditions emphasize that experience must be judged by scripture, community, ethical fruit, and humility rather than the other way around.[\[thegospelcoalition\]](#)[\[place.asburyseminary\]](#)[\[facebook\]](#)

In other words, the power of GODOG's criticism is not simply that it rejects belief. It forces believers to answer a much harder question: **How do you distinguish God's voice from your own desire, social suggestion, and institutional self-protection?** Once that question is taken seriously, religion stops being only a matter of "Do I feel it?" and becomes a broader inquiry into cognition, power, and human vulnerability.[\[theconversation\]](#)[\[cambridge\]](#)[\[thegospelcoalition\]](#)

If you want, I can next help you craft:

- a **more rigorous Christian counter-response** that directly addresses self-deception,
- or a **neutral analytic essay** on why religious systems are vulnerable to collective self-deception.

GODOG:

"經驗必須受經文、共同體、倫理果實與謙卑的自我懷疑所約束，而不是相反" - perfectly agree, but easily said than done. It might stand in the way with "faith". GODG probably can easily quote many verses in the Bible to argue "faith is certainty without proof" from the scripture itself. This also would likely to be reinforced by the preachers, the church, rituals and practices...so it may not be the wise response either.

You are right again: if the Bible can be read to support "faith as certainty about what is not seen," then a Christian who simply says "faith is humble and self-critical" may sound like they are dodging the text—or cherry-picking against a long-standing devotional tradition. Hebrews 11:1 is indeed commonly cited in translations and commentary as presenting faith as "assurance," "certainty," "conviction," or even "evidence" concerning unseen things.[\[biblehub\]](#)[\[biblegateway\]](#)[\[zondervanacademic\]](#)

中文

你的判斷很有分量：這不是一個容易用“理性平衡”就化解的問題。因為在很多教會語境裡，尤其是福音派傳統中，信心常常被講成一種堅定、確信、甚至不需外在可見證據的信靠；而《希伯來書》11:1 這類經文，確實很容易被用來支持這種語氣。再加上講道、見證、敬拜儀式與群體文化長期強化這種理解，信徒就可能真的把「確信」當成屬靈成熟的標誌，而把懷疑當成軟弱。

[[biblegateway](#)][[gotquestions](#)][[biblehub](#)]

所以，如果一個批評者（像 GODOG）抓住這點，其實不只是「誤讀」，而是抓住了基督教內部一個真實而長期存在的張力：信心究竟是對未見之事的合理信任，還是對未見之事的無條件確信？兩者差很多。前者還留有空間讓人自我修正；後者則很容易變成一種認知封閉，讓任何反證都被吸收進「更要相信」的框架裡。[[justinrossow](#)][[reddit](#)][[biblehub](#)]

因此，你說「這未必是明智的回應」，我同意。因為如果回應者太快把信仰說成「謙卑的懸置」「受經文約束的經驗」，在對手眼中就會像是：你明明所信的核心語言本來就鼓勵確信，現在卻突然把自己包裝成批判性、可修正的姿態。這樣容易被視為不一致。

[[zondervanacademic](#)][[gotquestions](#)][[biblehub](#)]

更重要的是，這不是只關於某一節經文，而是關於整個宗教生態：經文怎麼被講解、講道怎麼塑造信徒、教會如何處理疑問、見證如何變成規範、群體如何獎勵「堅定」而懲罰「遲疑」。在這種情況下，要求信徒單靠一句「經驗也要受約束」就跳出系統，確實不現實。GODOG 的批評之所以尖銳，就在於它不是只挑經文，而是在挑整個使經文運作的制度性脈絡。

[[thegospelcoalition](#)][[journals.sagepub](#)][[southampton.ac](#)]

如果要誠實地回應這一點，較成熟的基督徒答法可能不是「我的信仰不依賴確信」，而是：是的，基督教傳統中確實存在把信心理解為高度確信的傾向；但這種理解本身也需要被其他經文、神學傳統與倫理果子校正。也就是說，不是否認問題，而是承認張力，並承認信徒可能真的會在教會文化中學到一種過度自信的信仰語言。[[gotquestions](#)][[biblehub](#)][[zondervanacademic](#)]

English

You are right again: if the Bible itself can be read as supporting “faith as certainty about what is unseen,” then a Christian who simply says “faith is humble and self-critical” may sound evasive—or like they are selectively reading against a long devotional tradition. Hebrews 11:1 is indeed widely cited, in translation and commentary, as presenting faith as “assurance,” “certainty,” “conviction,” or even “evidence” regarding unseen things.[[biblehub](#)][[biblegateway](#)][[zondervanacademic](#)]

中文

你的判斷很有分量：這不是一個容易用“理性平衡”就化解的問題。在很多教會語境裡，尤其是福音派傳統中，信心常被講成一種堅定、確信、甚至不需外在可見證據的信靠；而《希伯來書》11:1 這類經文，確實很容易被用來支持這種語氣。再加上講道、見證、敬拜與群體文化長期強化這種理解，信徒就可能把「確信」當成屬靈成熟，把懷疑看成軟弱。[[biblegateway](#)][[gotquestions](#)][[biblehub](#)]

所以，如果批評者像 GODOG 那樣抓住這點，並不只是「誤讀」，而是抓住了基督教內部一個真實且長期存在的張力：信心究竟是對未見之事的合理信任，還是對未見之事的無條件確信？兩者差很多。前者仍留有自我修正空間；後者則很容易變成認知封閉，讓任何反證都被吸收進「更要相信」的框架。[\[reddit\]](#)[\[justinrossow\]](#)[\[biblehub\]](#)

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If you want, I can now help you craft a reply that is:

- **more honest about the Bible's own ambiguity, or**
- **more forceful in answering GODOG without sounding evasive.**